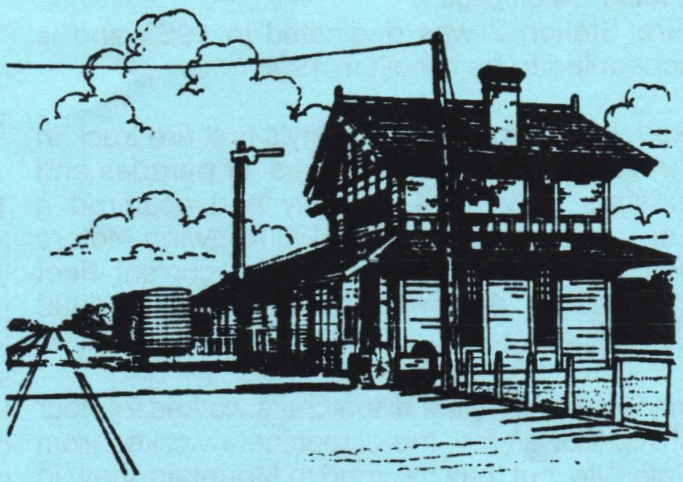
Mountain View Historical Association Newsletter

P.O. Box 252
Mountain View, CA 94042

Hilton U. Brown, III - Editor



Southern Pacific Depot — Mountain View, California, built in 1888

Barbecue & Raffle

The August Meeting

The Sunday, August 3, 1997 meeting of the Mountain View Historical Association will be our ***Fourth Annual Barbecue & Raffle.*** The place will be the Patio area at the Mountain View Senior Center, 266 Esquela Ave. This is the same location as last year.

You should have received a flyer in the mail recently about the ***Barbecue & Raffle.*** The flyer included a form to clip and return, along with your check, to let the Association know how many to plan for and how much food to prepare. If you lost or misplaced the flyer page 3 of this Newsletter duplicates the information, so clip that form and send it in! But do it right now, because the Historical Association needs to know you're coming!

No major business items, so that part of the meeting will be very brief. We are planning a little live music for entertainment. Al Jehning will do his magic with the hamburgers, and Art Walton will produce his legendary potato salad. There will be the usual fabulous raffle prizes.

The important part of day is the relaxed socializing. Bring your friends. Let us know you're coming, and we'll see you at the ***Fourth Annual Barbecue & Raffle.***

Fighting Fire & Disaster

The May Meeting

Battalion Chief John Fetz was the speaker for the May 4, 1997 Regular Meeting of the Mountain View Historical Association. He presented an illustrated history of the Mtn. View Fire Department. Chief Fetz will be remembered as a speaker on earthquake preparedness at the May 1994 meeting.

The history of the Mountain View Fire Department begins with a meeting of 50 volunteers April 1, 1874 to form *Hook and Ladder #1*. The volunteers purchased the equipment themselves. It was probably housed at the Rogers and Rogers store. May 17, 1905 the Mountain View Town Council passed a resolution formally creating the Volunteer Fire Department, and on June 7, *Hose Company #1* was formed. Hose Company #1 fought its first fire on October 29, 1905, and in April of 1906 it fought a fire at the Rogers and Rogers store. After that fire, a second fire company was formed.

The first Fire Station was built in 1924. It was replaced by Fire Station 1, which was built in 1953. The bell was the 1905 volunteer bell. A new Fire Station 1, located at the corner of Dana and Shoreline was dedicated in 1996.

(See Fire on page 2)

(From Fire on page 1)
Fire Station 2 was dedicated in 1953 and is scheduled to be rebuilt in 1998.

Redwine Motors built the city's first fire truck in 1917. This truck is still in use for parades and musters. By 1924 the City had acquired a LaFrace engine, and in 1930 Redwine Motors built still another engine. The current fleet includes six engines and one truck, all 1990 Seagraves.

In the early days the dispatchers worked 24 hour shifts. For a time, the dispatchers worked from Palo Alto, but they returned to Mountain View in 1980. The new Communications Center is located on the lower level of the Public Safety Building at 1000 Villa Street. This modern center provides 911 service and dispatch for Fire, Police, Public Services and Rangers. The whole operation is computer supported today.

The Volunteer Service was disbanded in 1964. Today a minimum of 18 persons are on duty. The Department now provides emergency medical services, deals with hazardous materials, performs fire safety inspections, fire investigations, water rescue, fire fighting, and mutual aid within and outside the county. Public education is a major activity of the Department which includes public event and school appearances for Sparky the Dog and Pluggy.

Chief Fetz showed pictures of the 1941 Junction Inn fire and the Chinatown Fire of 1946. One of Mountain View's worst disasters was the Jasco Chemical fire and explosion in April of 1965. 28 Firefighters were treated at El Camino Hospital. The most serious fire of recent times was the 6 Alarm Minton Lumber Fire. Units from as far away as Gilroy lent assistance.

The Mountain View Fire Department has been a proud and integral part of the City of Mountain View for more than one hundred years. The City is indeed fortunate in having the services of these dedicated men and women.

Executive Committee Meetings
June 7, June 18, July 8, 1997

The Executive Committee of the Mountain View Historical Association has met several times since the May Regular Meeting. We have reached agreement considering the collections to be housed in the new library. The collection space will be known as the Mountain View History Center. The Library Collection will contain items relating to the immediate vicinity of Mountain View which can be readily stored in filing cabinets or shelves. The Historical Association collection will also include these types of items but will continue to include some larger pieces. Where appropriate these pieces will be displayed in the Mtn. View History Center, but where they cannot be displayed the City will continue to make the fourth floor of City Hall space available.

The Executive Committee decided to oppose the proposed construction of a new office for the Chamber of Commerce in Pioneer Park. The tentative proposal would not have damaged any of the Heritage trees, and after removal of the present building a more useable park would remain. The objections are primarily to any sort of further encroachment on Pioneer Park, and the unknown impact upon interred remains.

The Executive Committee continues to support the Save The Adobe Task Force in its efforts to preserve and restore the Adobe Building.

Copies of the minutes of the regular and special Executive Committee meetings are available from the Association's Secretary or from the Newsletter Editor.

Mountain View Historical Association
Barbecue & Raffle
Sunday, August 3, 1997 — 1:00 P.M.

Senior Center
266 Esquela Ave.
Mtn. View, CA 94042

Menu:

Zesty Hamburgers
Condiments
Garden Fresh Green Salad
Art's Own Potato Salad
Baked Beans
Apple Pie

Cost:

Adults	$ 8.00 each
Children	$ 5.00 each
Raffle tickets	
	$ 1.00 each
Or 6 for	$ 5.00

Agenda:

1:00 PM	Registration
2:00 PM	Barbecue
3:25 PM	Business
3:30 PM	Raffle

Bring your own:

Table Settings
Beverages

Detach Here and Return Form Below

Barbecue Order Form

, or call
Edna Thompson
415-9673116

Send This Form With Your Check to:
MVHA Barbecue
P.O. Box 252
Mtn. View, CA 94042

Your Name and Phone: _____

Names of Guests: _____

Number of Adults ____ @ $ 8.00 = $ _____
Number of Children ____ @ $ 5.00 = $ _____

Total Amount Enclosed $ _____

Please Mail By:
July 25, 1997
Thank You

OLD NEWSPAPER ITEMS BY BARBARA KINCHEN

125 Years Ago (1872): "Our Wealthy Men" paid taxes based on the following assessed valuation:

Martin Murphy	$ 704,277
Castro-Calderon	92,940
S.B. Emerson	56,285
Henry Rengstorff	48,578
John Snyder	34,829
John Sullivan	30,950
L.P. Collins	27,318
Jeff Bailey	25,280
Frank Sleeper	24,925

There were 141 pupils attending public school.

A petition was submitted to the Board of Supervisors asking that Charleston Road be made a public road.

75 Years Ago (1922): Wages for apricot pickers were set at 40¢ an hour.

There were only two fires on the Fourth of July, both due to the combination of small boys and firecrackers.

A $197,000 bond election for buying land and building and furnishing a new high school carried by a vote of 684 to 188. The opposition came from an area where residents had wanted to unite with Palo Alto High School District.

An average of 77 patrons a day used the library which was open afternoons and evenings, except for sundays and holidays.

Theatrical Cold Cream, made by Owl Drug Company, sold locally at 75¢ a pound tin.

Powell Brothers Grocery hoped to entice customers with "Buy a dollar's worth of groceries and get a 25¢ watermelon free."

P G & E would install a gas system if 500 residents signed up for service.

A string of Percheron horses, 3 stallions and 3 mares, from the Rosehall Percheron Farm on Charleston Road, won the Grand Reserve Champion Ribbon at the California State Fair and 11 first premiums and 4 seconds.

The Woman's Club raised over $200 for its building fund with a Lady Minstrel Show and a Prize Cakewalk. Pop Smith congratulated the all-local entertainers for one of the best shows he had seen in his 30 years with the Register-Leader.

"Traffic violations continue to increase. People of all ages and conditions seem to take a sinister delight in defying the laws to protect human lives. In addition to the increasing menace from the traffic violators in the streets, we also have to contend with bicycle riders on the sidewalks. Lately we have heard of two ore more instances in which ladies were forced off of the sidewalks by men on bicycles."

50 Years Ago (1947): Many local people report seeing flying discs or saucers.

All Navy blimp activities along the Pacific coast are being discontinued and Moffett's blimp squadron is being transferred to North Carolina.

The local theatre showed The Egg and I starring Claudette Colbert and Fred Mac Murray.

The Sunnyvale Club, an organization of Italian families, has applied for a permit to build on Castro Avenue. (Now the Senior Center on the renamed Escuela Avenue.)

The play, I remember Mama, now running in San Francisco and also being filmed in Hollywood, was written by Katherine Anderson who graduated from Mountain View High School in 1925. She wrote under the name of Kathryn Forbes and was the daughter of Mr. and Mrs. Leon Ellis Anderson.

A midnight blaze lit the sky for miles when the three-story feed and storage barn burned at the Lawrence dairy farm on Charleston Road. The volunteer fire department fought the fire for 12 hours, assisted by Los Altos and the Division of Forestry at Alma Station. The 625 tons of hay were expected to burn for several days. All 25 cows and 2 bulls were led to safety. However, the bulls battled each other in the pasture where they were placed and when one escaped Officer Ed Henderson and Sgt. Art Nielsen had to quickly scramble over a barbwire fence. Chief Clarence Lawson badly injured a foot when he stepped on a nail. This was the fourth hay barn fire in the area in the last six weeks!

25 Years Ago (1972): An anonymous tip led to the discovery of 48 marijuana plants growing in a cornfield on Tyrella Avenue.

Mrs. Ruth Lawson replaced Mrs. Edith Duke as

Librarian. Budget cutbacks had kept the library closed on Fridays and. Sundays for the last year, but now Friday hours were restored.

Garbage collection rates rose from $1.62 to $1.86 a month, but there would no longer be backyard pickups. Instead, an unlimited number of cans could be placed at curbside.

Mrs. Christi Penkoff became the first female police officer for Mountain View.

The Chamber of Commerce-sponsored Mountain View's first Art and Wine festival, La Fiesta de Sierra Vista, featuring 40 artists and craftsmen. The two-day event drew 15,000 visitors.

A crowd of 1,000, including numerous local school children, greeted Mrs. Pat Nixon when she visited Ames Research Center.

The Holy Cross High School for girls and St. Francis High School for boys consolidated on September 11, 1972.

Chick Taylor retired after serving 12 years as Fire Chef at Moffett Naval Air Station. Previously, he had been with the Mountain View Volunteer Fire Department for 13 years.

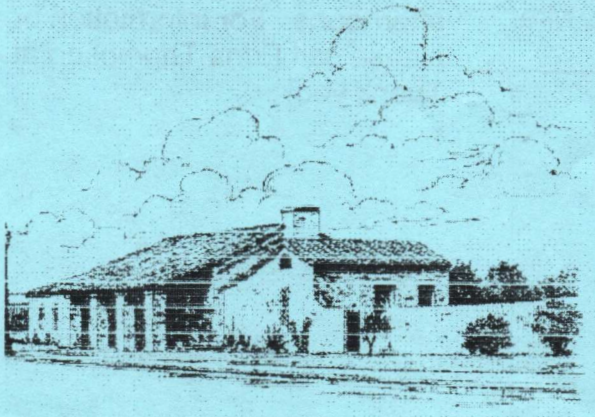
NEW TO THE PIONEER ROOM
BY BARBARA KINCHEN

From Lennart Ahlkvist: A house number plate in the form of a dirigible, which at one time was at 750 Bailey Avenue. Lennart rescued this when the house and others were being torn down for the widening of Bailey and building of the overpass.

From Virginia Miramontes Van Hook: A binder with samples of letterheads printed in the shop of her father, Percy Miramontes. He was employed at Pacific Press but also had his own print shop. Included are letters for Spangler Mortuaries, St. Paul Lutheran Church, The Boosters from Powell School, Schaffner Motors, Carl E. Anderson Co., Clyde C. Redwine and many others.

From Frances Rodrigo Trimmer: Picture of the June 1939 graduating class from Mountain View Highway Elementary School. France is in this class picture.

From Mrs. Margaret Meier of Durante, California: Snapshot of her mother, Ethel Baird, at Mountain View train station. She is in a two wheeled buggy with one horse. Undated.



SAVE THE ADOBE

In Commemoration

Esther Wikstrom Muir: 77, in Novato, March 24, 1997. Widow of Ray Muir (1984), mother of Gary Muir of Chloride, AZ and the late Larry Muir (1933) and a grandmother. Sister of the late Emil Wikstrom. She attended the Highway Grammar School and graduated from the Mountain View Union High School in 1937. She announced her engagement to Ray Muir at a party in the Adobe Hut. A member of the Mountain View Historical Association.

John Espinosa: 83, at Julia Health Care Center in Mountain View, May 6, 1997. A native of Hawaii. Survived by his wife, Antoinette Espinosa of Mountain View, daughter Dolores Cortez of Mountain View, son Richard Espinosa of Sunnyvale, and John Ronald Espinosa of Palmdale. Mr. Espinosa was a member of the Historical Association as was his son Richard, son-in-law Vincent Cortez and grandsons, John and Vincent, Jr.

Congratulations!

Congratulations to Mrs. Esther Stevens who celebrated her 100th birthday in May. Esther Frazer graduated from Mountain View High School in 1915. She was a school teacher, mother, step-mother, traveler and is still active and "on the go". Family and friends filled a church social hall for luncheon, tributes, and fun. Esther was married several times and might be remembered as Mrs. Kerrick, Mrs. Gravance or Mrs. Stevens.

Mountain View Historical Association Memorial Book

Donations have been made to:

Save the Adobe Fund

In Memory of: **Andrew Hingsberger**
From: Marge Bailey

In Memory of: **Jane Hingsberger**
From: Marge Bailey

In Memory of: **Robert K. Schatz**
From: Carmen and Ralph Faravelli
Frank and Marion Maita
Mary Lou Zoglin

The Memorial Fund

In Memory of: **Florence Wright Berger**
From: Barbara McPheeters Kinchen

In Memory of: **Stanley Thompson**
From: Edna Birkett Thompson

In Memory of: **Earl "Bud" Mockbee**
From: Eva G. Mockbee

In Memory of **Esther Wikstrom Muir**
From: Edna Birkett Thompson

In Memory of: **Clyde P. Shearer**
From: Elaine Marcetti Shearer

The Memorial Book may be viewed at the Pioneer Room, 4th Floor, Mountain View City Hall on Tuesday, Wednesday or Thursday afternoons. For information or applications please call Edna Thompson at 415-967-3116. Thank you!

Membership Report by Edna Thompson

A list of members of the Mountain View Historical Association is available to members from the Chair of the Membership Committee. Dues are $ 7.00 per year for an individual or $10.00 per year for a family, and Life Membership is $100.00 per person.

Life Members	49
Special Members	2
Honored Member	1
Individual Members	142
Family Members	55
Total Members	249

New Members (Since last Newsletter)

Life Members

Hilton Brown
Arthur Walton
Patricia Walton

New Individual Members

Roberta M. Canty
Anne G. Nichols

Life Members

Mario Ambra	Dena K. Bonnell
Hilton Brown	Reynolds Camp
Cliff Del Carlo	Alfred P. Chasuk
Ruth Erichsen	Wallace Erichsen
Carmen Farvelli	Ralph Faravelli
Roger Fellows	Patricia Figueroa
Marion Grimm	Estelle Stagg Heffelfinger
Bill Henderson	Eleanor McGlynn Henderson
Charles Hirschbek	DeWitt Hogle
Norene Hogle	Alice D. Holden
George Holden	George Jagels
Al Jehning	Robert W. Kirby
Joe Kleitman	Helen Shearer Krogh
Holly Urban Moore Leonard	Kenneth Richard Malovos
Madeline Chargon Malovos	Eva Mockbee
Gail Urban Moore	Mimi Mourkas
Patricia J. Reyburn	Elaine Marcetti Shearer
Nancy L. Smith	Richard M. Smith
Martin J. Spangler	Honor Spitz
H. Lee Stillers	Linda Swan
Joseph Sweeney	Roberta Sweeney
Edna Thompson	Sally Moore Taboada
Arthur Walton	Patricia Walton
John Viscovich	Bill Wissell

Association Officers and Board Members

President	Ralph Faravell
Past President & Social	Wally Erichsen
Vice President	Arthur Walton
Secretary	Eva Mockbee
Treasurer	June de Larios
Membership	Edna Thompson
Newsletter & Program	Hilton Brown
Hospitality	Mary Esther Walton
Memorial/Remembrance	Edna Thompson
Ways & Means	Joseph Sweeney
Historical Data	Barbara Kinchen
Amplification/Recording	Albert Jehning

Regular meetings of the Mountain View Historical Association are held on the first Sunday of February, May, August and November. The Newsletter is mailed approximately two weeks before each meeting. Deadline for copy for the Newsletter is the third Sunday before each meeting. Short items on appropriate topics submitted by any member of the Association will be considered for publication.

Treasurer's Report A.J. de Larios

April 1, 1997 - June 30, 1997

Balance 4/1/97		9,902.32
Income:		
Membership	407.00	
Sales	0.00	
Adobe Fund	100.00	
Memorial Fund	150.00	
Interest	12.82	
Total Income		669.82
Expenses:		
Administration	87.35	
Adobe	26.13	
Total Expense		113.48
Balance 6/30/97		10,458.66

Fund Balances:

Adobe Fund	2,603.43
Memorial Fund	225.00
Life Member Fund	4,900.00
General Fund	2,730.23

Investment:

$5,000, 9 month CD, 6.02%, matures 12/26/97

Mountain View Historical Association

Fourth Annual Barbecue & Raffle

Sunday, August 3, 1997
1:00 PM

Mountain View Senior Center
266 Escuela Avenue
Patio/Main Hall Area

MEMBERSHIP

ANY PERSON WHO SIGNIFIES INTEREST IN THE AIMS OF THIS ASSOCIATION AND WHO PAYS THE SPECIFIED ANNUAL DUES MAY BECOME A MEMBER OF THE ASSOCIATION.

AIMS: THE AIMS OF THIS ASSOCIATION ARE: TO GATHER AND PRESERVE HISTORICAL DATA RELATIVE TO THE EARLY SETTLEMENT AND DEVELOPMENT OF THE AREA IN AND AROUND THE PRESENT CITY OF MOUNTAIN VIEW; TO COLLECT, RECORD, EDIT AND PUBLISH A HISTORY OF THE PIONEERING ACTIVITIES OF THIS AREA; TO PRESERVE HISTORIC OBJECTS AND PLACES; TO COOPERATE WITH OTHER ORGANIZATIONS IN THE SANTA CLARA VALLEY ON PROJECTS DEEMED WORTHY BY OUR MEMBERSHIP.

MEMBERSHIP APPLICATION

NAME: _____

ADDRESS: _____

_____

_____

TELEPHONE: _____

TYPE: NEW____ RENEWAL____

REGULAR MEMBERSHIP $7.00/YR,
FAMILY MEMBERSHIP $10.00/YR,
LIFE MEMBERSHIP $100.00.

MAKE CHECK PAYABLE TO:
MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION
P.O. BOX 252, MOUNTAIN VIEW, CA 94042

MOUNTAIN VIEW
HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION
P.O. BOX 252
MOUNTAIN VIEW, CA 94042

SAN FRANCISCO, CA
PM
JUL 18
1997

FIRST CLASS MAIL

